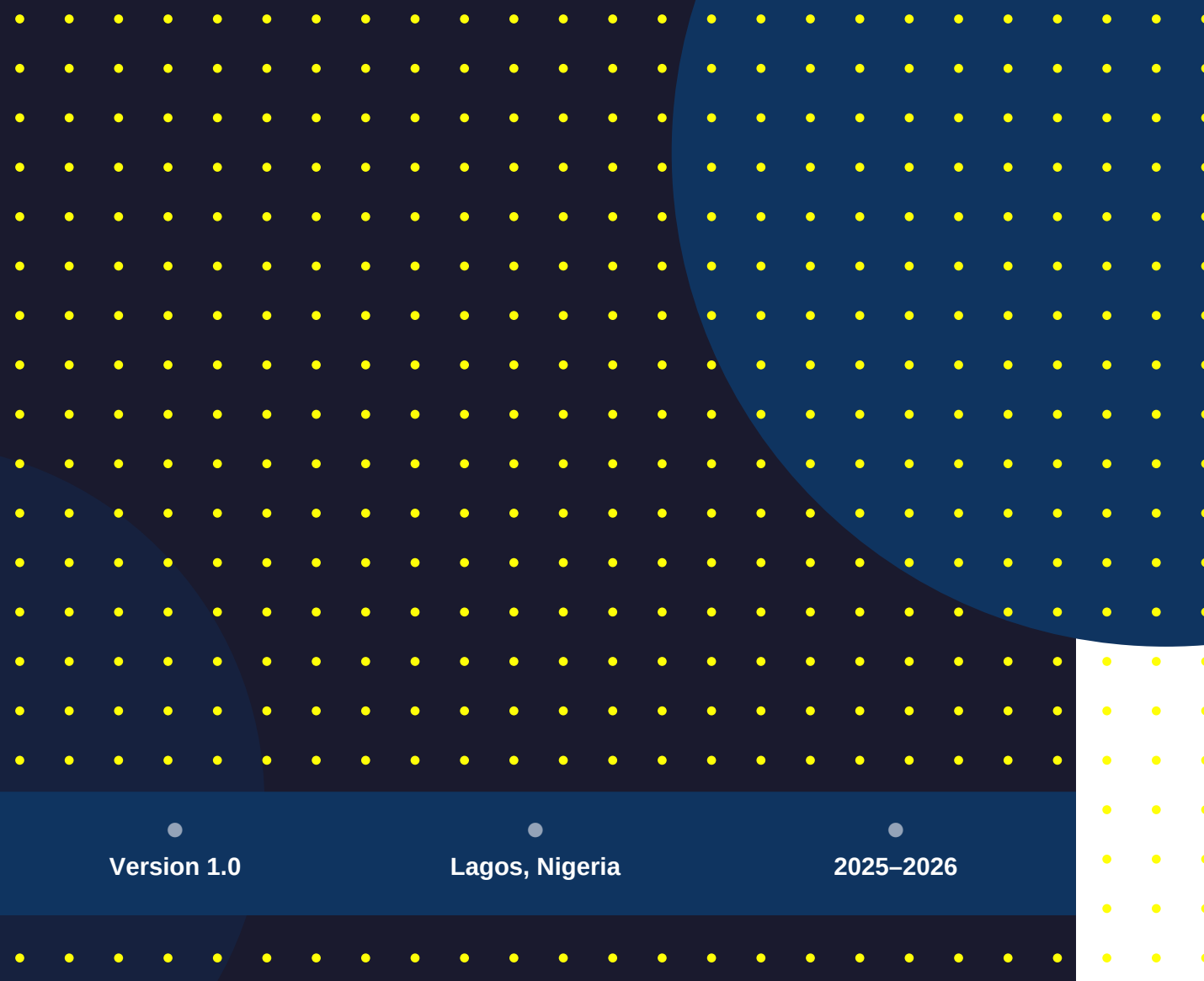




# HomeServe

Home Services Marketplace — Full Startup Blueprint

CONFIDENTIAL BUSINESS PLAN



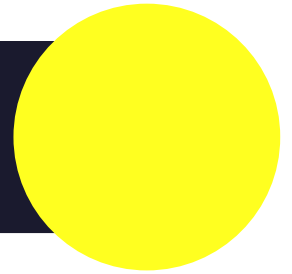
Version 1.0

Lagos, Nigeria

2025–2026

# The Elevator Pitch

How to explain your app in under 60 seconds



## Your One-Liner

"HomeServe is an Uber for home repairs — connecting Nigerians with verified, nearby artisans in minutes, with secure

## Pitch to a Friend (30 seconds)

You know how hard it is to find a reliable plumber or electrician when something breaks at home? You either call someone who might not show up, or you spend hours asking neighbours for a recommendation.

HomeServe fixes that. Open the app, pick what you need — plumbing, carpentry, electrical, whatever — and within minutes a verified artisan near you sees the request and accepts it.

You chat in the app, they come do the job, and you only pay once you're happy. The payment is protected — money is held securely until the job is done right. We take a small platform fee and you get quality, reliable help every time.

## Pitch to an Investor (60 seconds)

Nigeria has over 200 million people, the majority living in urban areas with ageing housing infrastructure and a massive informal artisan workforce — plumbers, electricians, carpenters — who currently find work through word of mouth alone.

HomeServe is a two-sided marketplace that formalises this market. Customers get verified, insured artisans on-demand. Workers get a steady stream of jobs, a digital reputation, and instant payouts. We take 10–15% of every transaction.

The home services market in Sub-Saharan Africa is valued at billions of dollars annually and is almost entirely undigitised. We are building the infrastructure layer for this workforce, starting in Lagos and expanding across Nigeria within 18 months.

# Services You Can Offer

Core services + expansion categories to dominate the market

## Phase 1 — Launch with These (Month 1–3)

Start with high-demand, high-frequency services where the pain point is clearest. Do not try to offer everything at once — master these first.

| ■ Plumbing                 | Leaky pipes, blocked drains, toilet repairs, water heater installation, geyser fitting |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Electrical Work          | Faulty wiring, new sockets, generator connection, inverter setup, meter issues         |
| ■ Carpentry                | Furniture repair, door & window fixing, wardrobes, shelving, wooden flooring           |
| ■ Computer & Tech Repair   | Laptop/PC repairs, virus removal, networking, CCTV installation, smart TV setup        |
| ■ Painting & Decorating    | Interior/exterior painting, wallpaper, POP ceiling, texture finishes                   |
| ❄️ ■ AC & Appliance Repair | Air conditioner servicing/repair, fridge, washing machine, microwave                   |

## Phase 2 — Add These After Launch (Month 4–9)

| ■ Cleaning Services       | Deep home cleaning, post-construction cleanup, office cleaning, sofa/carpet cleaning |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Landscaping & Gardening | Lawn mowing, garden design, tree trimming, flower bed setup                          |
| ■ Tiling & Waterproofing  | Bathroom/kitchen tiling, roof waterproofing, concrete sealing                        |
| ■ Security & Locksmith    | Lock repair/replacement, security door installation, key duplication                 |

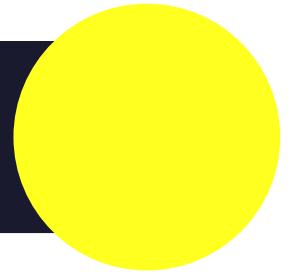
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|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Bathroom Renovation | Full bathroom remodels, toilet upgrades, shower installation |
| ■ Moving & Logistics  | Help moving furniture within a home or to a new apartment    |

### Phase 3 — Long-Term Expansion (Month 10+)

| ■ Home Tutoring             | Academic tutoring matched to students by subject and level         |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Home Healthcare           | Nurses, physiotherapists, lab sample collection at home            |
| ■ Auto Mechanic             | Mobile mechanic who comes to your location for car repairs         |
| ■ Beauty at Home            | Hairdressers, makeup artists, nail technicians dispatched to homes |
| ■ Pet Services              | Pet grooming, vet consultations, dog walking                       |
| ■ Photography               | Event and property photography for real estate/social media        |
| ■ Laundry & Dry Cleaning    | Pick-up and drop-off laundry service integrated into the app       |
| ■ Personal Chef / Meal Prep | Cooks for small events, weekly meal prep for busy professionals    |

# Step-by-Step Launch Plan

From idea to first paying customer — nothing skipped



## PHASE 1 — Validate (Weeks 1–2)

Do not build anything yet. Talk to real people first. This phase costs you nothing and saves you months of building the wrong thing.

|    |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Interview 20 Potential Customers</b><br>Ask: How do you find artisans now? What goes wrong? Would you pay extra for guaranteed quality? Record every answer.            |
| 02 | <b>Interview 20 Artisans</b><br>Visit trade markets, estates, and ask: How do you find work? Do you have slow months? Would you join an app? What would make you trust it? |
| 03 | <b>Study Your Competitors</b><br>Download and use Workman, GetFundi, Rewire. Note every frustration. That list is your product roadmap.                                    |
| 04 | <b>Define Your Edge</b><br>Based on interviews, identify the top 3 pain points competitors haven't solved. These become your headline features.                            |
| 05 | <b>Choose Your Launch Neighbourhood</b><br>Pick one specific area in Lagos — Lekki, Ikeja, Yaba. One area mastered is better than ten areas half-done.                     |

## PHASE 2 — Plan the Product (Weeks 3–4)

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Define All App Screens</b><br>List every screen: Splash, Onboarding, Login, Home, Service Categories, Job Request, Worker Profile, Chat, Payment, Review. Sketch them on paper first. |
| 02 | <b>Write Your Feature List</b><br>Split features into Must-Have (MVP), Should-Have (Version 2), and Nice-to-Have (Version 3). Be ruthless about what goes in MVP.                        |
| 03 | <b>Design Wireframes</b><br>Use Figma (free) to create simple, clickable wireframes. This becomes the brief you hand to your developer. No assumptions — everything drawn out.           |
| 04 | <b>Plan the Database Structure</b><br>Map out your data: Users, Workers, Jobs, Transactions, Messages, Reviews. Understand what information each feature needs to store.                 |

05

### Define Commission & Pricing

Decide: What % commission do you take? What are your service price bands? Do workers set their own price or does the app suggest one?

## PHASE 3 — Build (Months 1–3)

01

### Choose How to Build

Option A: Hire Flutter developer + backend developer. Option B: Use Bubble.io or FlutterFlow for no-code MVP. Start with Option B if budget is tight.

02

### Set Up Your Tech Infrastructure

Register with Firebase (free tier), Paystack (free to set up), Google Maps API, and Africa's Talking (for phone masking). Get API keys ready.

03

### Build Customer Side First

Sign up → Browse → Request Job → Track → Chat → Pay → Review. Get this flow working perfectly before touching the worker side.

04

### Build Worker Side

Register with ID → Create profile → Set skills & availability → Receive notifications → Accept job → Navigate to customer → Mark complete → Get paid.

05

### Build Admin Dashboard

Simple web panel where you see all jobs, all transactions, your earnings, and can resolve disputes. Build this in React.js.

06

### Integrate Paystack Escrow

Customer pays into escrow at booking. Money releases to worker only when customer confirms completion. Commission split happens automatically.

07

### Implement Phone Masking

Use Africa's Talking proxy numbers so neither party ever sees the other's real number. This prevents bypassing the platform.

08

### Beta Test with 20 Real Users

Find 10 customers and 10 workers willing to test. Run real jobs through the app. Watch them — don't explain, just observe where they get stuck.

09

### Fix, Polish, and Retest

Fix every bug found in beta. Improve onboarding flow. Make the app fast on a Tecno or Itel Android device specifically.

## PHASE 4 — Legal & Business Setup (Parallel to Phase 3)

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Register Your Business at CAC</b><br>Visit <a href="http://cac.gov.ng">cac.gov.ng</a> or use a registration agent. Register as a Limited Liability Company (LLC). Cost: approx ₦35,000–₦50,000 with agent fees.   |
| 02 | <b>Open a Business Bank Account</b><br>Use your CAC certificate to open a business account. GTBank, Zenith, or Access Bank are reliable. Paystack requires a business account.                                       |
| 03 | <b>Set Up Paystack Merchant Account</b><br>Go to <a href="https://paystack.com/signup">paystack.com/signup</a> . Submit your BVN, business registration, and bank account. Approval usually takes 1–3 business days. |
| 04 | <b>Draft Terms of Service</b><br>Hire a lawyer or use a legal template service. Key clauses: no off-platform transactions, dispute resolution process, commission rates, data privacy.                               |
| 05 | <b>Draft Worker Agreement</b><br>Workers sign this on registration. Covers: platform exclusivity for jobs found on app, ID verification consent, behaviour standards, account suspension rules.                      |
| 06 | <b>Get a Privacy Policy</b><br>Required for app store submissions. Use a generator like <a href="https://termly.io">Termly.io</a> for a starting point, then have a lawyer review it.                                |
| 07 | <b>Register for Tax (FIRS)</b><br>Register your company for taxes with FIRS. This protects you legally and is required when your revenue grows. A good accountant helps here.                                        |

## PHASE 5 — Launch (Month 3–4)

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Submit to App Stores</b><br>Submit to Google Play Store (one-time \$25 fee) and Apple App Store (annual \$99). Review takes 1–7 days. Have all screenshots and descriptions ready.          |
| 02 | <b>Recruit First 50 Workers Manually</b><br>Visit artisan markets, estate management offices, and trade unions. Hand out flyers. Personally onboard each worker and verify their ID.           |
| 03 | <b>Create Landing Page &amp; Social Media</b><br>Build a simple website (use Webflow or Carrd). Create Instagram, Facebook, and TikTok pages. Post behind-the-scenes of workers using the app. |
| 04 | <b>Launch Referral Incentives</b><br>First 100 customers: first job free. First 50 workers: zero commission for first 10 jobs. These early users become your loudest advocates.                |

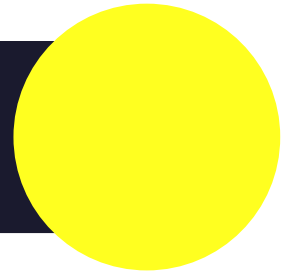
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|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 05 | <b>Run Targeted Social Media Ads</b><br>Facebook/Instagram ads targeted to your chosen Lagos neighbourhood. Budget ■30,000–■50,000 to start. Track cost per install and cost per first booking. |
| 06 | <b>Partner with Estate Managers</b><br>Gated estates have hundreds of households with constant service needs. Pitch to estate managers — offer them a dashboard to book services for residents. |

## PHASE 6 — Grow & Scale (Month 4–12)

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Track Your Core Metrics Weekly</b><br>Jobs completed, repeat booking rate, average rating, worker churn, customer acquisition cost. These numbers tell you what to fix.                  |
| 02 | <b>Introduce Pro Worker Tier</b><br>Workers with 4.8+ rating and 50+ jobs get Pro status — lower commission (8% vs 15%), priority placement, dedicated support line.                        |
| 03 | <b>Launch Home Care Subscriptions</b><br>Monthly plan for landlords and businesses: ■5,000/month for priority booking, discounts, and a pre-assigned team of verified workers.              |
| 04 | <b>Expand to 3 More Neighbourhoods</b><br>Once one neighbourhood is profitable, replicate the model — same playbook, new area. Speed up worker recruitment by partnering with trade unions. |
| 05 | <b>Launch in Abuja</b><br>Abuja has high-income residents and massive demand. Open an Abuja office (even a virtual one) and run the same neighbourhood-first strategy.                      |
| 06 | <b>Seek Seed Funding</b><br>With 6 months of data — bookings, revenue, growth rate — approach CcHUB, Lagos Innovates, or the Tony Elumelu Foundation with your pitch deck.                  |
| 07 | <b>Hire Your First Team Members</b><br>In order: Customer Support Agent, City Operations Manager, Marketing Manager. Don't hire before you need them, but don't wait too long either.       |

# How to Beat the Competition

Every differentiator you need to dominate the market



## ■ Escrow Payment Protection

Customer money is held securely until they confirm the job is done and satisfactory. No competitor does this properly in Nigeria. This one feature removes the biggest reason people don't trust these apps — fear of paying for bad work.

## ■ Masked Phone Numbers

Neither the customer nor worker ever sees the other's real number. All communication happens through the app. This makes off-platform transactions impossible and keeps both parties protected. Use Africa's Talking proxy number service.

## ■ Before & After Job Photos

Workers must upload photos before starting and after completing every job. This creates an evidence trail for disputes, builds the worker's portfolio automatically, and gives customers peace of mind. No other app in this market does this.

## ■ SOS Emergency Mode

One button to broadcast an urgent request to every available worker in a 10km radius. First to accept gets the job. Premium pricing applies automatically — customer pays more, worker earns more, platform earns more. This serves a massive unmet need.

## ■ Verified Worker Badges

Government ID check, skill verification, background check. Workers earn badges — Verified, Top Rated, Fast Responder, Pro. Customers immediately see who is trustworthy. Platforms that let anyone register are plagued with bad actors; yours will not be.

## ■ Worker Earnings Dashboard

Give workers a dashboard showing weekly/monthly earnings, rating trends, and tips to improve their profile. Instant bank withdrawals via Payoutstack. Workers who love your platform recruit other workers — your supply side grows itself.

## ■ Tamper-Proof Reviews

Only customers who completed and paid for a verified job can leave a review. No fake reviews, no gaming the system. Each review breaks down into Punctuality, Quality, Communication, and Value — giving future customers real, useful information.

## ■ Smart Re-Booking

After every completed job, a "Book [Worker Name] Again" button appears instantly. Monthly reminders for maintenance jobs. Favourite worker lists. These features make returning to the app the path of least resistance — easier than finding the number in their phone.

## ■ B2B Subscription Plans

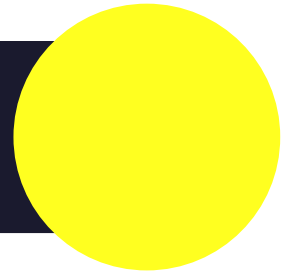
Landlords, property managers, and businesses that need services regularly pay a monthly subscription for priority access and discounted rates. This creates predictable recurring revenue and locks in your highest-value customers.

## ■ Smart Matching Algorithm

Don't just notify the nearest worker. Match based on rating, past job category, response history, and distance combined. A customer needing electrical work gets matched to an electrician with 50 electrical jobs completed — not a handyman who listed 'electrical' as a skill he tried once.

# Stopping Platform Bypass

How to keep customers and workers transacting on your app



Platform leakage — when customers collect a worker's number and book directly — is the single biggest threat to your revenue model. Here is your complete defence strategy.

|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Technical Prevention</b>        | Masked proxy numbers (Africa's Talking) mean customers never see the real number. In-app calling routes through the platform. Worker's personal number is never shown anywhere in the UI.                                       |
| <b>Value Lock-In for Customers</b> | 7-day job warranty only applies to app-booked jobs. Escrow protection only on the app. Job history, photos, and receipts stored permanently. Loyalty points only earned through the app.                                        |
| <b>Value Lock-In for Workers</b>   | Ratings and job history live on the platform — leaving means starting from zero. Weekly completion bonuses only paid through the app. Per-job insurance coverage only on app bookings. New customer flow comes through the app. |
| <b>Policy &amp; Enforcement</b>    | Workers sign an agreement at registration — soliciting off-platform is grounds for suspension. Customers report off-platform requests through the app. Tiered consequences: warning → suspension → permanent ban.               |
| <b>Pricing Psychology</b>          | The platform fee should never feel like a surcharge to the customer. Price it as included in the service. A customer should feel they're getting MORE value through the app, not paying extra.                                  |

# Tech Stack & Revenue Model

What to build with and how you make money

## Recommended Tech Stack

| Mobile App         | <b>Flutter</b>                       | One codebase for Android & iOS. Vital — Nigeria is 85%+ Android but you need iOS too.          |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Backend            | <b>Node.js + Express</b>             | Fast, scalable, huge developer community. Easy to find Node devs in Nigeria.                   |
| Database           | <b>PostgreSQL</b> + <b>Firestore</b> | PostgreSQL for jobs/users/transactions. Firebase Firestore for real-time chat & live location. |
| Authentication     | <b>Firebase Auth</b>                 | Email, phone number (OTP), and Google login. Free tier is very generous.                       |
| Payments           | <b>Paystack</b>                      | Nigeria's #1 payment processor. Supports cards, bank transfer, USSD. Split payments built in.  |
| Maps & Location    | <b>Google Maps API</b>               | Worker location tracking, distance calculation, route to customer.                             |
| Push Notifications | <b>Firebase Cloud Messaging</b>      | Instant job alerts to workers. Free and highly reliable.                                       |
| In-App Chat        | <b>Stream Chat SDK</b>               | Generous free tier, built for exactly this use case. Saves 3+ months of dev time.              |
| Phone Masking      | <b>Africa's Talking</b>              | Nigerian-focused telecom API. Proxy numbers to hide real phone numbers.                        |
| Admin Panel        | <b>React.js</b>                      | Web dashboard for you to manage everything. Not in the app stores.                             |
| File Storage       | <b>Firebase Storage</b>              | Store worker profile photos, ID documents, before/after job photos.                            |

## Revenue Streams

| Transaction Commission | <b>10–15% of every job</b> | Core revenue. 100 jobs/day at avg ₦5,000 = ₦50,000–₦75,000 daily. |
|------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                            |                                 |                                                               |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Emergency Surge Fee        | Extra 5% on SOS jobs            | Customers pay premium for urgency. Everyone wins.             |
| Pro Worker Subscription    | ■2,000–■5,000/month per worker  | Workers pay for lower commission rate + priority placement.   |
| Home Care Plan (Customers) | ■3,000–■5,000/month             | Landlords & businesses — recurring, predictable revenue.      |
| Featured Placement         | ■5,000–■15,000/month per worker | Workers pay to appear at the top of search in their category. |
| Insurance Add-on           | ■500–■1,000 per job             | Partner with a microinsurance provider. Opt-in per booking.   |
| B2B Enterprise Contracts   | Monthly retainer                | Property developers, hotel chains, facility managers.         |

# Legal Framework & Worker Agreement

Protecting your platform, your workers, and your customers

## Business Registration Checklist

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Register Business at CAC</b><br>Limited Liability Company (LLC). Visit <a href="http://cac.gov.ng">cac.gov.ng</a> or use an agent. Cost: ₦35,000–₦50,000. Get your Certificate of Incorporation and MEMAT. |
| 02 | <b>Open Business Bank Account</b><br>Required for Paystack. GTBank, Zenith, Access, or Opay Business. Bring: CAC cert, BVN, directors' IDs, utility bill for address.                                         |
| 03 | <b>Register with Paystack</b><br><a href="http://paystack.com">paystack.com</a> — submit business registration, bank details, BVN. Required to process payments legally. Takes 1–3 days to activate.          |
| 04 | <b>Register for Tax (FIRS)</b><br>Federal Inland Revenue Service. Register for Company Income Tax. File returns annually. Protects you legally as you scale.                                                  |
| 05 | <b>Register for VAT</b><br>If your annual revenue exceeds ₦25 million, VAT registration becomes mandatory. Set this up early to be prepared.                                                                  |
| 06 | <b>Data Protection Compliance</b><br>Register with NITDA under the Nigeria Data Protection Regulation (NDPR). You are storing users' personal data — this is legally required.                                |
| 07 | <b>App Store Developer Accounts</b><br>Google Play: one-time \$25. Apple App Store: \$99/year. Use your business name, not your personal name, for the accounts.                                              |

## Key Terms of Service Clauses

| No Off-Platform Transactions   | Users agree that all jobs found through the app must be booked and paid through the app. Violation = account suspension. |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No Direct Contact Solicitation | Workers may not ask for customer phone numbers or social media. Customers may not ask workers to accept direct payment.  |

|                             |                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Escrow Payment Terms        | Customer payment is held in escrow until job completion is confirmed. Disputes must be raised within 24 hours of job completion.  |
| Worker Verification Consent | Workers consent to ID verification, background checks, and their profile being visible to customers in their area.                |
| Dispute Resolution Process  | Disputes are reviewed within 48 hours. Platform decision is final. Fraudulent claims result in account suspension.                |
| Commission Acknowledgment   | Workers acknowledge the platform commission rate and agree it applies to all jobs originated through the app.                     |
| Behaviour Standards         | Workers must arrive on time, communicate professionally, and complete jobs to a reasonable standard. Poor behaviour = suspension. |
| Account Termination         | Accounts can be suspended for: off-platform solicitation, fake reviews, abusive behaviour, or repeated customer complaints.       |

# 12-Month Roadmap

Month-by-month milestones from day one to scale

| Month           | Milestone                 | Key Actions                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Month 1</b>  | <b>Validate</b>           | Conduct 40 interviews. Study competitors. Define your MVP features. Sketch wireframes in Figma.                                              |
| <b>Month 2</b>  | <b>Plan &amp; Design</b>  | Finalise wireframes. Write developer brief. Choose tech approach (Flutter dev or no-code). Set up Firebase & Paystack accounts.              |
| <b>Month 3</b>  | <b>Build MVP</b>          | Core booking flow complete. Paystack escrow integrated. In-app chat working. Admin dashboard live. Internal testing begins.                  |
| <b>Month 4</b>  | <b>Beta Launch</b>        | 50 workers onboarded manually. 100 customers invited in one Lagos neighbourhood. Real jobs, real money, real feedback.                       |
| <b>Month 5</b>  | <b>Fix &amp; Optimise</b> | Address all beta feedback. Improve onboarding speed. Reduce job acceptance time. Fix notification reliability. Retest on Tecno/Itel devices. |
| <b>Month 6</b>  | <b>Public Launch</b>      | Submit to Google Play and App Store. Run first paid social media ads. Estate manager partnerships. Referral programme activated.             |
| <b>Month 7</b>  | <b>Grow</b>               | Expand to 3 more Lagos neighbourhoods. Launch Pro Worker tier. Begin tracking repeat booking rate and customer LTV.                          |
| <b>Month 8</b>  | <b>Monetise</b>           | Launch Home Care subscription plan. Introduce featured placement for workers. Add first Phase 2 services (cleaning, security).               |
| <b>Month 9</b>  | <b>Partnerships</b>       | Sign B2B deal with 2–3 estate management companies. Explore insurance partner integration. Start building Abuja worker network.              |
| <b>Month 10</b> | <b>Abuja Launch</b>       | Soft launch in Abuja with 30+ verified workers. Run same neighbourhood-first strategy. Lagos team helps onboard Abuja workers remotely.      |
| <b>Month 11</b> | <b>Funding Prep</b>       | Compile 6-month metrics deck. Total jobs, GMV, revenue, growth rate, retention. Begin conversations with CcHUB, Lagos Innovates, TEF.        |
| <b>Month 12</b> | <b>Series Seed</b>        | Pitch to investors with data. Hire Operations Manager and Customer Support Lead. Plan 2026 expansion to PH, Kano, and Ibadan.                |

# Funding & Resources

Where to get money, tools, and support in Nigeria

## Nigerian Startup Funding Sources

| <b>Tony Elumelu Foundation</b>    | <a href="http://tefonline.org">tefonline.org</a>                                                           | Up to \$5,000 grant + mentorship for African entrepreneurs. Apply annually.                |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>CcHUB Growth Capital</b>       | <a href="http://cchub.africa">cchub.africa</a>                                                             | Nigeria's leading tech hub. Pre-seed and seed investment for tech startups.                |
| <b>Lagos Innovates</b>            | <a href="http://lagosstate.gov.ng/innovates">lagosstate.gov.ng/innovates</a>                               | Lagos State Government programme — grants, workspace, mentorship for Lagos-based startups. |
| <b>Ventures Platform</b>          | <a href="http://venturesplatform.com">venturesplatform.com</a>                                             | African-focused VC fund. Pre-seed to Series A. Strong portfolio in Nigerian tech.          |
| <b>Google for Startups Africa</b> | <a href="http://startup.google.com/intl/en/programs/africa">startup.google.com/intl/en/programs/africa</a> | Up to \$100k Google Cloud credits, mentorship, and network access.                         |
| <b>Future Africa</b>              | <a href="http://future.africa">future.africa</a>                                                           | Nigeria-based VC. Backs early-stage African startups with \$25k–\$150k.                    |
| <b>NIRSAL Microfinance Bank</b>   | <a href="http://nirsal-mfb.com.ng">nirsal-mfb.com.ng</a>                                                   | Government-backed loans for Nigerian SMEs and startups at low interest rates.              |

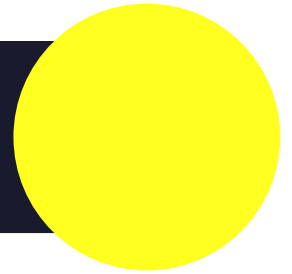
## Free & Low-Cost Tools to Build Your Business

| Tool            | Website                                                      | Cost           | Used For                                                   |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Figma</b>    | <a href="http://figma.com">figma.com</a>                     | Free           | UI/UX design and wireframing                               |
| <b>Firebase</b> | <a href="http://firebase.google.com">firebase.google.com</a> | Free tier      | Backend, auth, database, storage, notifications            |
| <b>Flutter</b>  | <a href="http://flutter.dev">flutter.dev</a>                 | Free           | Cross-platform mobile app development                      |
| <b>Paystack</b> | <a href="http://paystack.com">paystack.com</a>               | Free to set up | Payment processing (they take 1.5% + ₦100 per transaction) |

|                              |                                                                         |                         |                                                     |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Africa's Talking</b>      | <a href="https://africastalking.com">africastalking.com</a>             | <b>Pay per use</b>      | Phone masking, SMS, USSD                            |
| <b>Stream Chat</b>           | <a href="https://getstream.io">getstream.io</a>                         | <b>Free tier</b>        | In-app messaging SDK                                |
| <b>Google Maps Platform</b>  | <a href="https://console.cloud.google.com">console.cloud.google.com</a> | <b>\$200 free/month</b> | Maps, location, routing                             |
| <b>Bubble.io</b>             | <a href="https://bubble.io">bubble.io</a>                               | <b>From \$29/month</b>  | No-code app builder for MVP                         |
| <b>Notion</b>                | <a href="https://notion.so">notion.so</a>                               | <b>Free</b>             | Product planning, documentation, task tracking      |
| <b>Carrd</b>                 | <a href="https://carrd.co">carrd.co</a>                                 | <b>Free / \$9/year</b>  | Simple landing page for your app                    |
| <b>Canva</b>                 | <a href="https://canva.com">canva.com</a>                               | <b>Free</b>             | Marketing graphics, social media posts, pitch decks |
| <b>WhatsApp Business API</b> | <a href="https://business.whatsapp.com">business.whatsapp.com</a>       | <b>Low cost</b>         | Customer support and notifications                  |

# Your Action Plan for This Week

The only five things that matter right now



Everything in this document can feel overwhelming when you read it all at once. But you only need to do one thing: start. Here is your action plan for the next 7 days.

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Talk to 5 Potential Customers Today</b><br>Not tomorrow. Today. Call friends, family, neighbours. Ask them: how do you find artisans? What goes wrong? Would you use an app for this?                                    |
| 02 | <b>Talk to 5 Artisans This Week</b><br>Visit a local market or estate. Find a plumber, electrician, or carpenter. Ask them about their work and whether they'd join your platform.                                          |
| 03 | <b>Create a Free Figma Account</b><br>Go to <a href="https://figma.com">figma.com</a> , sign up free, and start sketching your app screens. Even rough boxes and arrows. Getting your idea visual makes everything clearer. |
| 04 | <b>Register Your Business Name</b><br>Go to <a href="https://search.cac.gov.ng">search.cac.gov.ng</a> and check if your app name is available. Reserve it. This costs nothing to check and very little to register.         |
| 05 | <b>Write Down Your 3 Edge Features</b><br>Based on your customer conversations, identify the 3 things your app will do that none of the existing apps do properly. These become your brand.                                 |

**The best time to start was yesterday.**  
**The second best time is right now.**

HomeServe — Built in Nigeria, for Nigeria.